Teachers' Challenges in Enhancing Reading Comprehension Among Junior High School Students at Placido L. Señor National High School

A Research Proposal

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By: **Group 2**

Sellar, April R.

Wenceslao, Angel P.

Simoy, Rheane M.

Basalo, John Liefer D.

Lapiz,Vince Clark C.

Lapiz, Rolando T.

Jumalon, John Michael M.

Antone, Apple Joy

Labinghisa, Ellah A.

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Rationale

Students' performance in a variety of disciplines and their overall academic achievement are directly impacted by reading comprehension, which is a fundamental component of learning. Identifying the obstacles that prevent successful teaching and learning, especially in the setting of Placido L. Señor National High School, requires an understanding of these difficulties. The research hopes to help create focused tactics, professional development courses, and regulations that assist educators in their teaching responsibilities by bringing these difficulties to light. Additionally, by shedding light on the regional difficulties educators encounter, this study contributes to the field of education research and may be useful as a guide for communities in related academic contexts looking for efficient methods to improve literacy capabilities.

Reading comprehension is a fundamental ability that affects learning in many subject areas, not just language classes. Nonetheless, instructors sometimes face considerable obstacles when trying to help junior high school pupils develop this ability, especially in the unique setting of Placido L. Señor National High School. In order to lay the groundwork for practical remedies, our research aims to investigate these issues and comprehend the causes behind them.

Furthermore, resolving this issue is essential to assist educators in improving their teaching strategies and assisting learners in developing their literacy. It is anticipated that the research's conclusions would not only help the school's instructors and students but also offer insightful information to those involved in the educational community. By concentrating on the particular difficulties that the school's teachers encounter, the study adds to regional and national educational research by providing methods and suggestions for enhancing reading comprehension practices in comparable settings. In the end, this

study emphasizes how critical it is to provide educators with the resources and assistance they require in order to overcome these obstacles and guarantee students' academic achievement.

CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

Introduction

There are many challenges teachers must go through in terms of developing reading comprehension and the benefits can be seen after the teacher implements them, education stakeholders (Astuti, & Lammers, 2017). Students' ability to learn and their overall academic achievement are greatly influenced by their reading comprehension. It entails interpreting, evaluating, and synthesizing information, which are critical abilities for successful learning and go beyond simply comprehending words on a page. Students with strong reading comprehension skills are better able to understand difficult ideas, make connections between concepts, and remember information from a variety of areas. Additionally, it develops critical thinking, problem-solving, and information evaluation skills—all of which are essential for overcoming obstacles in the classroom and in real-world circumstances (Prayuda, et al, 2023).

A number of critical demands must be met in order for teachers to support their efforts to promote student learning and effectively teach reading comprehension. In order to assist students, engage with the subject, it is crucial that they have access to a variety of reading materials that are both relevant and diverse. These materials should be suitable for a range of interests and reading levels and should also be culturally relevant. Teachers can fulfill the diverse requirements of their pupils by using tactics like differentiated instruction, scaffolding, and schema activation, which are provided via ongoing professional development through training and seminars. Teachers also need enough time to prepare

lessons that include interesting pre-reading exercises and follow-up assignments, as well as to give difficult readers specialized help (Osamwonyy, 2016).

Students' varied origins, reading skills, and degrees of prior knowledge all have a big impact on how well they understand readings in the classroom. Their growth may be hampered by things like a small vocabulary, a lack of drive, and insufficient access to reading materials outside of the classroom. Furthermore, psychological and emotional obstacles such as worry or a lack of confidence in one's reading skills may also affect one's capacity to interact with and comprehend texts. The study runs the danger of providing an insufficient picture of the elements that lead to reading comprehension difficulties if these student-centered issues are not addressed.

To bridge this gap, the research could include a deeper investigation into the students' perspectives, behaviors, and external circumstances. By conducting student surveys, interviews, or focus groups, the study can identify the specific obstacles that learners face in developing reading comprehension skills. This approach would allow for a more holistic understanding of the issue, shedding light on how students'

individual challenges intersect with teachers' struggles. Ultimately, incorporating these insights can guide the development of more targeted and effective strategies that benefit both teachers and students, ensuring a comprehensive approach to improving reading comprehension outcomes (Hezam, et al, 2022).

This study investigates the challenges faced by teachers in teaching in teaching reading comprehension to Junior high school students in the Placido L. senor National High School it identifies factors like limited resources student reading abilities and external influence like parental support and socioeconomic status the study emphasize to overcome

these obstacles and improve reading comprehension education student learning experiences and academic excellence within the institution

Theoretical Background

This study is anchored on the schema theory, which emphasizes the role of prior knowledge and mental frameworks in understanding new information. In the context of reading comprehension, students rely on their existing schemas to interpret texts and connect with their meanings. Teachers at Placido L. Senor National High School may encounter challenges when students lack the necessary background knowledge, making it difficult to bridge the gap between the text and the students' understanding. These gaps can hinder comprehension and engagement, highlighting the need for effective teaching strategies.

According to the Schema theory, which was first proposed by Frederic Bartlett in 1932, people use cognitive frameworks called schemas to organize and understand information. These schemas offer a framework for processing new information, which helps with comprehension and memory recall. Bartlett's theory highlights that recall can be highly dependable in some situations, especially when dealing with known or culturally meaningful material, even though it is frequently misinterpreted as implying that memory is fundamentally unreliable (Ost et al., 2022).

Conceptual Framework

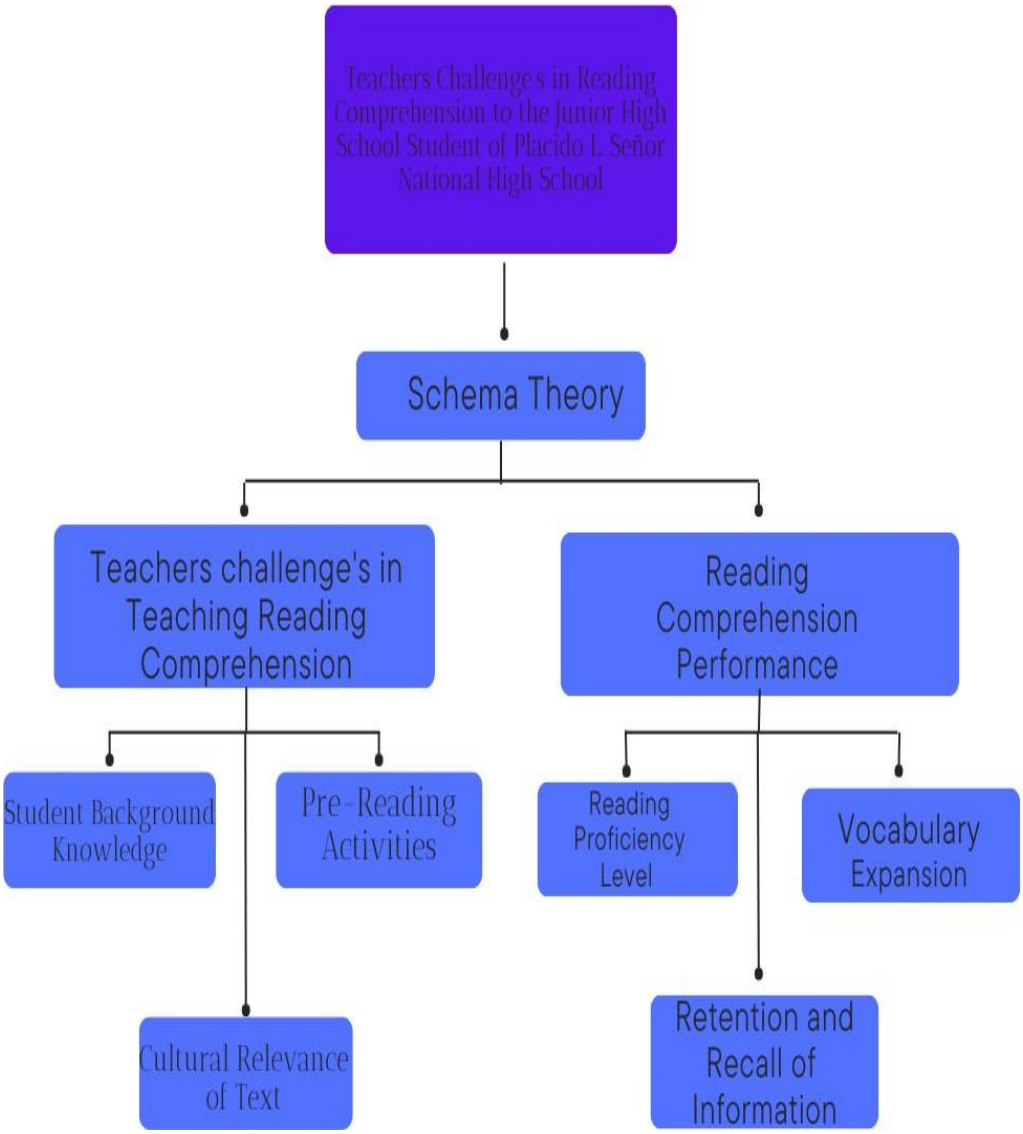

Figure1: Theoretical framework based on the theory 'Schema Theory' Frederic Bartlett in 1932,

Statement of the Problem

This study aims to determine how teachers are challenged in the process teaching reading comprehension among Junior High School students.

In this study, the researchers want to determine the following:

1. What challenges do teachers encounters in teaching reading comprehension to junior high school?

2. What strategies and source can be used to improve the Reading comprehension of Junior High School at Placido L. Senor National High School?

3. How do these challenges affect student reading comprehension skill?

4. What reading comprehension development in Junior High School at Placido L. Senor National High School?

5. What is the case study of junior high school?

Significance of the Study

This study seeks to explore the challenges faced by teachers in teaching reading comprehension to Junior High School (JHS) students at the Placido L. Senor National High School. By identifying these challenges and addressing them through effective strategies, the study provides the following significant benefits:

Students Junior High School pupils are the key beneficiaries of the study, increased teaching tactics will provide students with more opportunities to improve their reading comprehension skills, resulting in increased academic achievement and critical thinking ability

The **Teachers** findings will help teachers understand the specific issues they face when teaching reading comprehension. These insights can help them build more effective teaching methods, resources, and interventions that improve students' learning outcomes

School Administration findings can be used by school administrators to construct professional development programs and give tools to help instructors overcome problems. This will ensure that the school's teaching and learning processes are continuously improved.

Future Researcher This study can serve as a reference for future researchers who wish to explore similar subjects or perform studies in relevant areas.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

Research Design

This method enables a thorough investigation of the experiences, viewpoints, and difficulties teachers have when instructing reading comprehension. Techniques like focus groups, interviews, and classroom observations can offer deep, comprehensive understandings of the problem. As an alternative, a mixed-method study design that incorporates both qualitative and quantitative techniques could be used. While focus groups or interviews could reveal the underlying causes and contextual experiences, surveys or questionnaires could document the scope of the difficulties. This strategy would combine quantifiable facts with in-depth observations to offer a balanced viewpoint. Whether the objective is to obtain a thorough knowledge or to generalize findings for wider use will determine the final design option.

Environment

This environment includes the physical setting of the school, such as classrooms, libraries, and other facilities where reading comprehension activities and teaching occur. It also involves the participants, particularly the junior high school students and their teachers engaged in reading comprehension lessons. Additionally, the socio-cultural context plays a significant role, including community influences, language, and cultural factors that shape students' reading habits and comprehension abilities. The environment also covers the availability and use of educational

resources, such as books, teaching materials, and technology that support reading instruction. Lastly, it examines specific challenges faced by teachers, such as limited resources, student engagement issues, and curriculum constraints, which directly impact the teaching and learning process. This comprehensive setting forms the backdrop for understanding the dynamics of teaching and reading comprehension challenges within the school.

Figure 2: Map of the Placido L. Senor National High School

Respondents

The respondents will be the Junior high students from Placido L. Señor National High School. The study's focus is on their experiences, methods of instruction, and difficulties in mentoring pupils. Junior high school students also act as responders since their reading comprehension skills and engagement levels provide insight into the challenges faced by educators. Other stakeholders, such curriculum creators or school administrators, could occasionally also be regarded as respondents if their positions have a major impact on the resources available for reading instruction or the teaching environment. When taken as a whole, these responders offer insightful information on the challenges of teaching and acquiring reading comprehension in the classroom.

Instruments

The instrument should be designed to gather both qualitative and quantitative data to comprehensively understand the challenges faced by teachers. Here are potential instruments can be used:

Questionnaire or Survey: Develop a structured questionnaire with both closed- ended and open-ended questions. Include sections on teachers' perceptions, teaching methods, challenges, and suggestions for improvement. Use a Likert scale to measure the level of agreement or frequency of specific challenges.

Interviews: Conduct semi-structured interviews with teachers to gather in-depth qualitative insights into their experiences, challenges, and coping strategies. Use open- ended questions to allow participants to elaborate on their responses.

Focus Group Discussions: Organize group discussions with teachers to foster dialogue and uncover common challenges and shared experiences. This method can reveal nuanced perspectives that might not emerge in individual settings.

Classroom Observations: Observe classroom interactions to identify practical challenges teachers face when teaching reading comprehension. Focus on teaching techniques, student engagement, and any noticeable barriers during lessons.

Document Analysis: Review teaching materials, lesson plans, and student work to identify potential gaps or difficulties in reading comprehension instruction.

Data-Gathering Procedure

To carry out the study, the researcher would first obtain the required approvals from the school administration and other relevant parties. The research tools, including questionnaires, would then be created and verified to guarantee their efficacy and dependability in data collection.

When the tools are prepared, the researcher will give the junior high school teachers questionnaires to fill out to learn more about their viewpoints, methods, and difficulties when it comes to teaching reading comprehension. To get more in-depth knowledge about instructors' and maybe students' experiences, the researcher would interview them one-on- one or in groups if interviews are a component of the approach. A checklist might also be used for classroom observations to record interactions and instructional strategies during reading comprehension exercises. To augment the data, the researcher may also, if appropriate, examine already-published materials, such as the outcomes of students' reading comprehension assessments.

To better understand the difficulties instructors, have while teaching reading comprehension, the researcher would arrange and examine the data once it had been collected to find trends and themes. The study topic will be thoroughly and comprehensively investigated thanks to this process.

Definition of Terms

"Teachers' Challenges" refers to the several challenges and barriers that educators have while trying to help their pupils become more proficient readers, such as a lack of resources, a lack of time, or problems with student involvement.

"Reading comprehension" describes a student's capacity to comprehend, analyze, and extrapolate meaning from written material. This includes abilities such as summarizing, analyzing, and drawing conclusions.

Students in Grades 7 through 10 are referred to as **"Junior High School Students"**

in this research, which focuses on their comprehension levels.

"Placido L. Señor National High School" is the precise establishment that serves as the research's focal point.

APPENDICES

Appendix A

Survey Questionnaire

I. Profile of the Respondents Directions: Please provide your personal information by filling in the blanks below.

Name: _____

Age: _____

Gender: _____

Grade Level: _____

Years of Teaching Experience: _____

II. Perception of the Respondents Regarding Challenges in Teaching Reading Comprehension

Directions: Please rate your responses on the following statements using the scale below. Indicate your response with a check (√)

5 – Strongly Agree

4 – Agree

3 – Neutral

2 - Disagree

1 - Strongly Disagree

A. Controllability

Indicators					
1. Challenges in Classroom Management It is difficult to address the diverse reading comprehension levels of students in one classroom.					
2. Large class sizes hinder the effective teaching of reading comprehension.					
3. Students' lack of interest in reading affects their comprehension ability.					
4. The limited availability of appropriate teaching materials poses a challenge.					
5. Time constraints limit the implementation of comprehensive reading activities.					

B. Reliability/Validity

Indicators	1	2	3	4	5
1.Challenges Related to Student Engagement Students have difficulty understanding texts due to a lack of background knowledge.					
2. Students are often distracted, making it challenging to sustain their focus during reading activities.					
3. Vocabulary limitations greatly hinder students' reading comprehension.					
4. Students find it hard to develop critical thinking skills needed for advanced reading comprehension					
5. It is challenging to motivate students to apply learned reading comprehension strategies independently.					

C. Usability

Indicators	1	2	3	4	5
1. Challenges in Assessment and Evaluation Designing assessments that effectively measure students' reading comprehension is challenging.					
2. Assessing individual students in a large class is difficult.					
3. Providing constructive feedback on students' comprehension performance requires significant time.					
4. Current evaluation methods do not fully reflect students' reading comprehension progress.					
5. There is a lack of effective tools and guidelines for assessing reading comprehension skills.					

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